

AFRIVATE TEAM SPACE — PORTAL USER GUIDE

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This is the **full** how-to guide for Afrivate Team Space (all roles, including Admin). It is written in plain English.

Role-specific guides: Staff / ordinary team members use **AFRI-PUG-02** (Staff Portal Guide). Team leads and assistant leads use **AFRI-PUG-03** (Team Lead Portal Guide). People & Culture and Administrators use this document (AFRI-PUG-01).

In one minute: Team Space is the official work website. If something needs a **record** (leave, a weekly update, a learning certificate, a policy you have read, an appraisal), it belongs here. If something is just a **chat**, use Slack. WhatsApp is only for informal or emergency contact. AVA can show you the right page, but she never submits anything for you.

1. THE GOLDEN RULE: WHICH TOOL TO USE

Tool	Use it for	Do not use it for
Portal (Team Space)	Anything that must be recorded: leave, weekly updates, tasks, learning proof, surveys, shout-outs, growth plans, memos, appraisals, discipline, PIPs, your personal details, and signing that you have read a policy.	Casual chat.
Slack	Official day-to-day messaging. Reply to official Slack messages within four (4) hours on official work days.	Leave, policy acknowledgements, appraisals, or any process that needs a Portal record. A Slack message does not count as a Portal submission.
Email (hr@afrivate.org)	Official company broadcasts and formal correspondence. Replies should usually come within one (1) working day.	Day-to-day team chat.
Alison	Taking the assigned online course.	Proving you finished it — that proof goes in the Portal.

Tool	Use it for	Do not use it for
Google Drive	Master copies of policies and contracts.	The everyday staff copy — those live under Resources .
WhatsApp	Informal or emergency contact only.	Leave, policy acknowledgements, appraisals, or any formal People & Culture process.
AVA	Asking “how do I...?” and being taken to the right page.	Completing work for you. AVA never submits, approves, or deletes anything.

Remember: If it needs a stamp of “this happened, and here is the proof,” use the Portal.

2. WHO CAN DO WHAT

Everyone sees a **role** on their profile. That role decides what extra buttons you get.

Role you see	What you can do
Team member	Everyday work: tasks, leave requests, weekly updates, learning, surveys, shout-outs, My info, growth tools, notes, memos (read), resources, calendar.
Assistant lead	Everything a team member can do, plus approve leave for the people you manage, and see their weekly updates.
Team lead	Everything an assistant lead can do, plus publish memos and add calendar events.
People & culture (HR)	Everything above, plus the Admin area: approvals, leave for the whole organisation, the HR dashboard, Recruitment, and the Employee hub.
Administrator	Everything HR can do, plus change someone’s role, and manage departments and teams.

Leads usually see the people who report to them, the people on their team, or the people in a department they head. Only **Administrators** can change a person’s role.

3. GETTING INTO THE PORTAL

Website: **portal.afprivate.org**

Request access (first time)

You cannot just walk in. Someone from People & Culture (or an Administrator) must approve you.

1. On the login screen, click **Request access**.
2. Enter your full name, work email, and a password.
3. Choose your department and type your job title. You may add a short message.
4. Click submit.

Password rules: at least 8 characters, with one uppercase letter, and one number or symbol. After you submit, you wait. You may be able to sign in, but you will see a “waiting for approval” screen until HR or

Admin clicks **Approve** under **Admin** → **Approvals**.

Sign in

1. Go to the portal and open **Sign in**.
2. Enter your email and password, then click sign in.
3. Or use a **magic link**: enter your email, ask for a link, open the email, and click it. No password needed that time.
4. If your account is not approved yet, you will see a waiting screen.

Forgot your password

1. On the login screen, click **Forgot password**.
2. Enter your email, open the message you receive, and click the link.
3. Set a new password (same rules as above) and sign in again.

Change email or password later

1. Click your name or photo in the top-right corner.
2. Open **Account & security**.
3. Change your email (you will confirm via email) or set a new password.

You can read the privacy notice at any time from Account or [/privacy](#) . To leave, click your name → **Sign out** and confirm.

4. FINDING YOUR WAY AROUND

The left menu (computer)

Menu item	In everyday words
Home	"What needs my attention today?"
My work	Your to-do list and the work assigned to you.
Inbox	Alerts: shout-outs, leave updates, assignments, and similar.
People	Leave, shout-outs, learning, surveys, growth, your details, and the staff list.
Search	Type a name or word and jump to the matching page.
Weekly update	Tell the team what you finished this week.
Getting started	Welcome videos and a first-week checklist (mainly for new joiners).
Notes	Meeting notes and knowledge pages, like a simple wiki.
Memos	Official company or team updates.
Resources	Policies, handbooks, and templates.
Calendar	Team events and meetings.

Menu item	In everyday words
Admin	Only People & Culture and Administrators see this.

On a phone

The bottom bar shows **Home**, **My work**, **Inbox**, **People**, and **More**. Tap **More** (or the menu icon at the top) to open the full list.

The top bar (every page)

- **Dark / light mode** — the sun or moon icon.
- **Search** — jumps to the Search page.
- **Availability** — Available, Away, Busy, or Focusing. This shows on the Directory.
- **Live / Presence offline** — “Live” means the portal can show who is online. If presence is offline, availability may not update for others until it reconnects.
- **Bell** — Inbox. A red dot means you have unread items.
- **Your photo / name** — opens My profile, Account & security, and Sign out.

On some phones and computers a banner may appear: **Install AfriVate Portal**. If you tap Install, the portal sits on your home screen like a normal app.

A purple **AVA** button sits in the bottom-right on a computer, and just above the bottom menu on a phone. See section 23.

5. HOME

Path: Home (the first page after you sign in)

Home is your “good morning” page. It greets you by name and shows what needs attention.

What you will see

- Shortcut buttons: **New task**, **Request leave**, **Submit check-in**.
- Numbers for: tasks due today, leave waiting (yours, or yours to approve if you are a lead), unread memos, and events coming in the next 7 days.
- Coloured reminder banners if you have an open survey, a learning certificate due, or a policy you have not yet acknowledged.
- If you joined in the last 30 days: a **Getting started** progress bar for onboarding videos.
- Today’s events and the latest memos (open one to read it and mark it as read).

What to do: Start here each work day. Tap any banner or card — it takes you to the right page. Clear banners by actually doing the thing (submit the survey, upload the certificate, acknowledge the policy).

6. MY WORK (TASKS)

Path: My work

This is the shared to-do list. You can create work, assign it to people, track status, and mark it complete. When someone marks a task complete, the portal stores **who** did it and **when**.

Views: Board (columns: Up next → In progress → Complete / Stuck), **List** (grouped by due date), and **Week** (laid out across the current week).

Filters: Mine / Owned / Assigned; status; priority (urgent, normal, later); category; and search by title.

How to create a task

1. Click **New task** (from Home or My work).
2. Fill in a title (required). Add a description if it helps.
3. Choose assignees, a due date, priority, category, estimated hours, hours already spent, and any blockers.
4. Save.

How to update a task

1. Open the task. Change status, add comments, update hours or blockers.
2. Move it: **Up next** → **In progress** → **Complete**. If you are stuck, mark it **Stuck** and write what is blocking you.
3. When the work is finished, mark **Complete**. Do not just tell someone on Slack — the Portal timestamp is the official record.

7. INBOX

Path: Inbox (or the bell in the top bar)

Inbox is not email. It is a list of portal alerts for you: shout-outs and comments, tasks assigned to you or mentions, leave approved/declined or a comment on your request, survey reminders, a new memo, access approved or denied, or a department change.

1. Open Inbox.
2. Tap an item — it is marked as read and you jump to the related page.
3. Use **Mark all as read** if you want the red dot gone.

8. SEARCH

Path: Search (or the search icon in the top bar)

Type a person's name, a memo title, a task, a document name, or any keyword. Results can include people, memos, tasks, notes, documents, events, leave, shout-outs, surveys, learning, OKRs, and (for HR) recruitment and related records. You only see what your role is allowed to see.

9. WEEKLY UPDATE

Path: Weekly update

Every week you tell the team four simple things: what you **finished**, what you will do **next**, anything **blocking** you, and how many **hours** you worked. You can choose who sees it: your **department**, or **everyone**.

1. Open **Weekly update**. Stay on **This week**.
2. Fill in the four fields, choose visibility, and submit. You can come back and edit the same week later.
3. Open **History** to see your past weeks.

Leads open the **Team** tab to see who has submitted. HR can also review the whole organisation under **Admin** → **Check-ins**. A Slack “I was busy this week” message is not a substitute.

10. GETTING STARTED (ONBOARDING)

Path: Getting started

This page is mainly for people who just joined.

- **Videos:** Watch the welcome videos in order. Mark them watched as you go. Home shows your progress for the first 30 days.
- **Checklist:** Tick first-week items as you complete them (some items may tick themselves when you do the related Portal action).

People & Culture add and edit videos and checklist items under **Admin** → **Onboarding**.

11. NOTES

Path: Notes

Notes are shared pages — meeting notes, plans, how-we-do-things write-ups. They can nest under other pages, like folders.

1. Create a page and write in the editor.
2. Choose who can see it: **Private**, **Workspace** (everyone), **Departments** or **Teams**, or named **People**.
3. You can share a link when link sharing is turned on.
4. Delete only when you are sure — it is removed for everyone who had access.

12. MEMOS

Path: Memos

Memos are official written updates from the company or a department. Some HR digests here are the same content HR also sends by email. Each memo has a title, body (or an attached document that is the body), a category, a priority (**Info**, **Important**, or **Urgent**), an audience, and optional pictures or files.

How to read: Open Memos, filter or search if needed, read the memo, and mark it as read. Home will keep reminding you about unread ones.

Who can publish: Team lead and above can write and publish memos. Drafts can save on your own device until you are ready. Set the audience (everyone or a department) and priority. HR / Admin can edit or delete memos. HR can draft an HR digest from the HR dashboard.

If your account is **suspended**, Memos is one of the two areas you can still read (the other is Resources).

13. RESOURCES (POLICIES AND FILES)

Path: Resources

This is the filing cabinet: handbooks, policies, templates, and similar files. Some files are open to everyone. Some are **HR only**. Some are **management only**. Some require you to click that you have read them (acknowledge).

1. Browse by category, or search by name.
2. Open a file to preview it, or download it.
3. If the file needs acknowledgement, complete that action. Home and People will keep a yellow banner until you do.

HR can upload files (from the computer or Google Drive), set the category, and tick Requires acknowledgement, HR only, or Management only. HR can also see who has acknowledged a policy from the HR dashboard. If your account is **suspended**, you can still read Resources.

14. CALENDAR

Path: Calendar

The team calendar of events. Views: list, schedule (month / week / day), and a Google Calendar view if one is connected. Browse upcoming events and click one for time, place, and who it is for. Events may be for everyone or for a department. **Team lead and above** can create events (title, date, start/end time, location, audience). Drafts can save locally before you publish.

15. PEOPLE HUB

Path: People

People is one place for “anything about humans at AfriVate” that is not Admin. Tabs: Overview · Time off · Shout-outs · Learning · Surveys · Growth · My info · Directory.

Overview has shortcuts, the same reminder banners as Home, recent HR digest memos, a team snapshot for leads (combined numbers only — individual survey answers stay with HR), and a **PIP & suspension** list for leads, HR, and admin.

16. TIME OFF (LEAVE)

Path: People → Time off

This is the **only official way** to request leave. A WhatsApp message, a Slack ping, a phone call, or a verbal “I’m off tomorrow” is **not** an approved request (except a true emergency, which you still record here as soon as you can).

Type	Everyday meaning	Typical allowance shown
Annual	Planned holiday / vacation	20 days
Sick	You are unwell	10 days

Type	Everyday meaning	Typical allowance shown
Emergency	Sudden, unavoidable absence	7 days

Except accepted emergencies, give at least **three (3) official work days' notice**. Finish or hand over your work, and tell colleagues on Slack, before you go.

How to request leave

1. Open **People** → **Time off** (or Home → Request leave, or ask AVA → Go to Time off).
2. Click **Request leave**.
3. Choose start date, end date, type (annual / sick / emergency), and a reason.
4. Attach a supporting file if needed (for example a medical note). You can upload a file or pick one from Google Drive.
5. Confirm, then submit. Watch status under **My requests**: pending → approved or declined.
6. You and your manager can leave comments on the request.

How leads approve: Open People → Time off → Team requests (or All requests if you are HR). Read the dates, reason, and any attachment. Approve or Decline with a short note. Use the Calendar tab to see who is off. HR can also approve from **Admin** → **Leave**. Until the Portal says **approved**, you are not on approved leave.

17. SHOUT-OUTS

Path: People → Shout-outs

This is the praise wall. Thank a colleague in public and tag it with a value. People & Culture manage the tag list.

1. Compose a shout-out. Choose the person, write a short message, pick a tag, and add a photo if you like.
2. Send. It appears on the feed. Others can like and comment.

HR can remove a shout-out if it should not stay on the feed.

18. LEARNING (ALISON COURSES)

Path: People → Learning

AfriVate assigns courses on **Alison** (an external learning website). You take the course there. You **prove you finished** it here.

1. Open **People** → **Learning** and open the assigned Alison course.
2. Finish the course on Alison and download or photograph your certificate.
3. Back in the Portal, enter the course name, the completion date, and upload the certificate (or pick it from Google Drive).
4. Submit. Status is **pending** until HR reviews it. If HR rejects it, fix what they asked for and resubmit.

Home and People will show a banner until your proof is in. HR publishes assignments and reviews certificates from this page and from the HR dashboard.

19. SURVEYS

Path: People → Surveys

From time to time HR opens a short survey: **Pulse** (how are you finding work), **eNPS** (would you recommend AfriVate as a place to work), or **Onboarding**. One response per person. Your individual answers go to HR. Leads may see combined team scores, not your personal answers.

1. Open **People** → **Surveys**, or tap the Home / People banner.
2. Open the active survey, answer the questions, and submit.

HR launches surveys, sends reminders, and reads results under **Admin** → **HR dashboard**.

20. GROWTH

Path: People → Growth

This is your performance and voice area.

Tab	What it is, in plain English
OKRs	Objectives and Key Results — what you are aiming at this quarter, and how you will know you got there. Add an objective and key results; update them as you progress.
1:1s	A regular conversation with your manager (usually monthly). You meet outside the portal. Then the manager marks the 1:1 complete here so HR can see it happened.
IDP	Individual Development Plan — your written plan for growing skills. Write it, submit it, and respond if your manager leaves notes. HR can review IDPs from Admin.
Feedback	When HR opens a 360° cycle, you may rate yourself, your manager, a peer, or someone who reports to you. Complete the form while the cycle is open.
Milestones	Day 30 / 60 / 90 checkpoints for new joiners. Tick them when you have had that conversation or review.
Awards	When quarterly awards are announced, you can see winners here.
Speak up	A confidential way to raise a workplace concern. Choose a category, write what happened, and submit. HR receives it. This is for real concerns, not for leave requests or IT niggles.

21. MY INFO

Path: People → My info

This is **your** personal record for HR. Keep it accurate. Incomplete records create extra chasing from People & Culture.

You can update: preferred name and legal name, personal email and phone, work location and country, date of birth, pronouns, LinkedIn, bio and skills, emergency contact (name, phone, relationship), and next-of-kin notes.

You cannot change yourself: employment status, engagement type (employee / volunteer / contractor), probation dates, payroll flags, and other HR-only fields. Those live under **Admin** → **Employees**.

Fill in the form, check the **profile completeness** percentage, and click **Save my info**. If HR has asked you to review your details, you will see an amber banner until you save an update.

22. DIRECTORY

Path: People → Directory (or My profile in the top-right menu)

The staff list. Search by name. Open a person to see job title, department, contact details, availability, and (if you are allowed) PIP or suspension status. Edit your own profile card (photo, bio, phone, skills, LinkedIn). HR / Admin can edit other people's cards and assign department or team. Availability (Available / Away / Busy / Focusing) comes from the top-bar control.

23. AVA — THE IN-PORTAL HELPER

Where: Purple AVA button (bottom-right on a computer; above the phone menu)

AVA means AfriVate Virtual Assistant. She is a help desk inside the portal — not a manager, and not a robot that does your work.

She can: answer how-to questions; explain the four-hour Slack rule and which tool to use; show a **Go to...** button that opens the right page; and use a snapshot of your open tasks, leave, and surveys so the answer fits you.

She cannot: submit, approve, reject, edit, or delete anything; fill in a leave form or weekly update and save it for you; replace a People & Culture decision; see records you are not allowed to see; or give salary, legal, or confidential HR advice. For those, email hr@afriivate.org.

1. Click **AVA**.
2. Type a question, or tap a suggested prompt (for example "How do I request leave?").
3. Read the steps. If a **Go to...** button appears, click it.
4. Complete the action yourself on that page.
5. Close AVA with the close button or the Escape key.

If AVA is down, use this User Guide under **Resources**, or email hr@afriivate.org.

24. PIP AND SUSPENSION (DUTY STATUS)

People & Culture (and Administrators) can set a person's **duty status**. This is separate from the everyday "Available / Away" control.

Status	What it means for the person	Who can see the badge
Normal duty	Ordinary access. No special badge.	—
On PIP	You are on a Performance Improvement Plan. You keep full portal access . A banner reminds you. Your lead, HR, and admin can see the badge.	You, team leads, HR, admin
Suspended	You can still sign in . You can read Memos and Resources , and manage Account & security . You cannot use the rest of the portal until HR lifts it. A red banner explains this.	You, team leads, HR, admin

HR sets this on the person's Employee hub dossier or under **Admin → Users**. Placing someone on PIP here does not automatically write the full formal PIP paperwork — that still happens under Discipline & PIP when needed. If you are suspended and you try to open another page, the portal sends you back to Memos.

25. ADMIN — FOR PEOPLE & CULTURE AND ADMINISTRATORS

Path: Admin — HR and Admin roles only

Admin is the back office. Staff do not see it. Tabs: Approvals · Recruitment · Users · Departments · Teams · Announcements · Leave · Onboarding · Check-ins · HR dashboard · Employees. **Departments** and **Teams** are Administrator only.

Approvals

People who requested access wait here. Open the request, check name, email, department, and job title. Set the right role if needed. Click **Approve** (they can use the portal) or **Deny** (they stay out and can request again later). You can also invite someone by email if they have not requested yet.

Users

The list of portal accounts. Search people. Edit department, job title, who they report to, and whether the account is active. Set duty status (normal / on PIP / suspended) — you will be asked to confirm.

Administrators only can change role. You cannot deactivate your own signed-in account. Deactivating someone means they can no longer sign in. That is different from suspension, where they can still sign in with a locked-down view.

Departments (Administrator only)

Create, rename, or delete departments. Optionally assign a department head. Assigning a person to a department can update their reporting line to that head.

Teams (Administrator only)

Create teams with a lead, optional assistant lead, and a link to a department. Add or remove members. A person's department may align with the team's department when you add them.

Announcements

Moderate organisation-wide memos from Admin: create, edit, delete, set audience and priority. Same content as the Memos page, from the HR/Admin side.

Leave

The organisation-wide leave queue and calendar. Approve or decline pending requests, add a note, and (when authorised) delete a request.

Onboarding

Add, edit, or remove welcome videos (YouTube links, section, duration) and checklist items that new joiners see under Getting started.

Check-ins

A digest of everyone's weekly updates. Filter by week or department. This is how HR sees who submitted and what they wrote.

HR dashboard

The people-operations overview. Numbers typically include headcount, engagement, eNPS, learning completion, 1:1 rate, leave, grievances, surveys, attrition, time-to-hire, policy acknowledgements, OKRs, recognition, onboarding CSAT, **active PIPs**, **pending discipline**, **probation due**, and **people on suspension**.

From this dashboard you can also: export KPIs; assign Alison courses and review certificates; launch pulse / eNPS surveys, manage templates, and remind non-responders; manage awards, IDP review, policy acknowledgements, exit interviews, and grievances; open 360° feedback cycles, assign reviewers, and manage templates; draft an HR digest memo; adjust portal labels (categories and tags); and open the Revival launch checklist if you are on the allowlist.

26. EMPLOYEE HUB (HR RECORDS)

Path: Admin → Employees

This is the system of record for each person's employment file. Tabs: Directory · Discipline & PIP · Appraisals · Probation · Lead scorecards · Offboarding · Audit.

Directory and person dossier

Search active people by engagement type, employment status, and how complete their My info is. Open a dossier (the full file) for one person. On a dossier you can:

- Set **duty status**: Normal duty, On PIP, or Suspended (with a confirmation).
- Set engagement (employee / volunteer / contractor) and status (active, probation, on leave, exiting, terminated, archived).
- Record start date, probation end, confirmation date, payroll setup, contract or volunteer terms.
- Keep HR-private notes (these stay off the default PDF).
- **Request employee to update My Info** — they see a banner on My info.
- Review discipline history and open a new case.
- **Export PDF** (optionally include discipline) and **Archive** when appropriate.

Discipline & PIP

AfriVate uses a stepped process: (1) Coaching / verbal, (2) Written warning, (3) Performance Improvement Plan (PIP), (4) Restricted duties, (5) Termination case.

When you record a case, capture severity (low, medium, high, critical), the trigger (for example missed deadlines, communication, absence, misconduct, underperformance), and how it was delivered (portal notice, meeting, formal email, written letter). You can **Activate (HR)** immediately, or save a **pending recommendation** for HR to approve. Termination stays carefully gated.

For an active PIP: track goals and review cadence, mark whether the person is on track, and close with passed / extended / escalated / terminated recommendation. Creating a PIP step can auto-create a PIP with templated goals and duration. Setting duty status to "On PIP" on the dossier is the visible badge; the Discipline tab is the formal paperwork. Close both when the plan ends.

Appraisals

Formal appraisals score two parts: **60%** output / deliverables and **40%** soft skills / behaviour. Those two scores become one overall percentage and a band:

Overall score	Band
70% or more	Exceptional
60–69%	Good
50–59%	Performance concern — coaching
40–49%	Disciplinary / corrective
Below 40%	Termination consideration

Usual cadence: quarterly, or monthly while someone is on an active PIP. Save drafts, finalise, and keep history on the person's record. Use the branded Performance Appraisal Form as a printable worksheet if you need paper.

Probation

See who is approaching a probation end date. Confirm them into active status and store the confirmation details.

Lead scorecards

Track quality signals for leads — for example delivery consistency, KPI completion, communication discipline, and escalation quality.

Offboarding

When someone is leaving, start a checklist and pick a reason. Work through the default items: finish or reassign Portal tasks, final weekly update, knowledge transfer, revoke access (email, Slack, Portal), collect assets, exit interview notes, and volunteer Code of Conduct notices when relevant. Tick items as done.

Audit

A chronological log of HR actions on profiles, discipline, PIPs, appraisals, and offboarding. Use it when you need to see who changed what, and when.

27. RECRUITMENT

Path: Admin → Recruitment

This is the applicant tracker for open roles. It is for People & Culture (and Admin), not for general staff. You can define scoring criteria for a role, connect Gmail (the HR mailbox) so applications can sync in, search candidates, preview CVs, read the application email, rank / rescore candidates, and move people through stages: **Applied** → **Screen** → **Interview** → **Offer** → **Hired** or **Rejected**. When the portal asks you to connect Gmail, complete the Google sign-in popup. Treat applications as confidential.

28. SPECIAL: REVIVAL LAUNCH CHECKLIST

Path: /launch-checklist (also linked from the HR dashboard)

Only named launch owners can open this. It is a shared playbook for a specific launch (portal readiness, memos, WhatsApp drafts, Alison, surveys, town halls, and similar). Most staff will never see this page.

29. QUICK “WHERE DO I...?” CHEAT SHEET

I want to...	Go here
Request leave	People → Time off (or AVA → Go to Time off)
Approve leave	People → Time off (leads) or Admin → Leave (HR)
Submit my weekly update	Weekly update (or AVA → Go to Weekly update)
Add or complete a task	My work
Read a company memo	Memos
Acknowledge a policy	Resources (or the Home banner)
Submit my Alison certificate	People → Learning (or AVA → Go to Learning)
Fill in a survey	People → Surveys
Update emergency contact	People → My info
Find a colleague's email	People → Directory or Search
Thank a colleague	People → Shout-outs
Write my quarterly goals	People → Growth → OKRs
Raise a confidential concern	People → Growth → Speak up
Ask how to do something	AVA (then complete the action yourself)
Change my password	Top-right → Account & security
Publish a memo	Memos (team lead+) or Admin → Announcements

I want to...	Go here
Approve a new joiner	Admin → Approvals
Change someone's role	Admin → Users (Administrator only)
Put someone on PIP or suspension	Admin → Employees (dossier) or Admin → Users
Record a PIP or appraisal	Admin → Employees
Review job applications	Admin → Recruitment
See organisation health numbers	Admin → HR dashboard

30. A GOOD WEEKLY HABIT

1. Open **Home**. Clear the banners (survey, learning, policy).
2. Put leave and any formal People & Culture matter in the **Portal** — not WhatsApp or Slack.
3. Keep **My work** honest. Mark tasks **Complete** so the time and the person are recorded.
4. Submit the **Weekly update** before the week closes.
5. Keep **My info** complete so HR does not have to chase you.
6. Use **Slack** for chat. Use the Portal whenever something must be on the record.
7. If you are lost, ask **AVA**, then do the click yourself on the page she opens.

31. IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

What you see	What it usually means	What to do
Waiting / pending approval screen	Your access request is not approved yet.	Wait, or email hr@afprivate.org .
Red banner: account on suspension	HR has paused most portal actions.	You can still read Memos and Resources. Contact HR if you think this is a mistake.
Amber banner: you are on a PIP	You are on a Performance Improvement Plan.	Keep using the portal as usual. Talk to your lead and HR.
"We couldn't load your data"	A temporary connection problem.	Click Retry. If it lasts, refresh the page or try again later.
"Some profile details could not be loaded"	Part of your profile failed to load.	Click Refresh. You can still use the portal.
"Your browser storage is full"	The browser ran out of local space (often old notes or drafts).	Dismiss the banner; clear old notes or drafts if you can.
AVA does not answer	The helper is unavailable.	Use this guide in Resources, or email hr@afprivate.org .

What you see	What it usually means	What to do
Magic / reset link expired	The email link is old.	Request a new link from the login screen.
Presence offline	Live “who is online” is down.	You can still work. Availability may not show for others until it returns.

For access or People & Culture questions, email hr@afriate.org or speak to your designated People & Culture representative.